

# PORTFOLIO

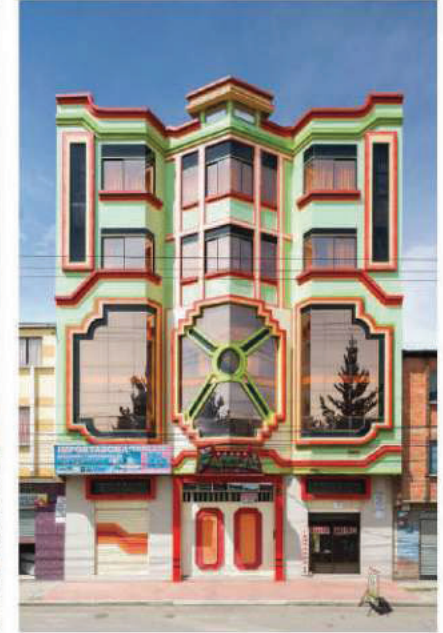
Sanika Paranjpe

# 01 वसुधैव कुटुम्बकम्

Taking Freddy Mamani's Neo Andean Architecture from Bolivia as its starting point, this collection is an intersection of Craft, Research, Cultures, and Design. It is an attempt at mobilizing high levels of local skill & tradition to sustain local communities. There is a use of traditional techniques with contemporary design approach. Optimal usage of the fabric crafted by the community is ensured.

The collection is made with handspun and handwoven Eri Silk. Organic dyes made from locally available dyestuffs are used. The women of the Rabha tribe from Loharghat, Assam have spun, dyed, and woven the fabrics used in the collection. Eri silk is considered to be the most sustainable type of silk whereby the moth is not killed for the extraction of the fiber. Eri silk's cooling property in summers and warming properties in winters add a seasonless attribute to the garments.

Keywords: Eri silk, organic dyeing, responsible fashion, contemporary weaves, sustainable, geometric, easy silhouettes.



## Organic Dyed swatches:



**1. Vitamin**  
Dyestuff:  
Turmeric +  
Marigold Petals



**2. Indigo**  
Dyestuff:  
Assam Indigo  
(Rom)



**3. Lime**  
Dyestuffs:  
Turmeric +  
Dry Onion Peels.



**4. Millet**  
Dyestuffs:  
2 Parts Harda in  
water

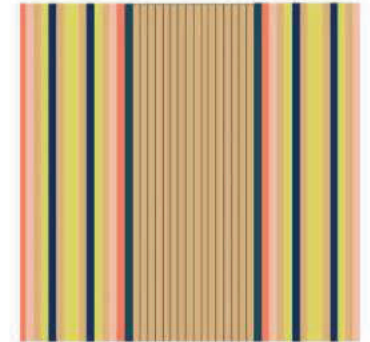
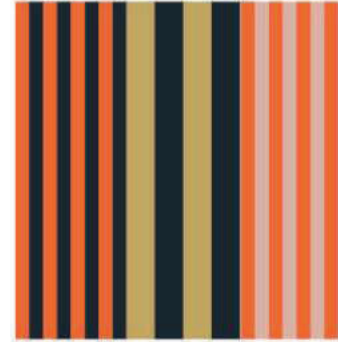
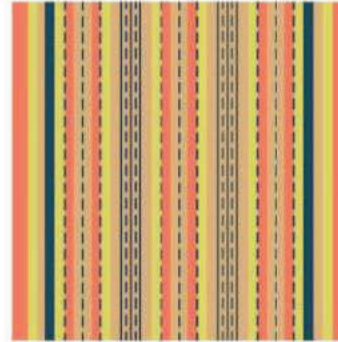
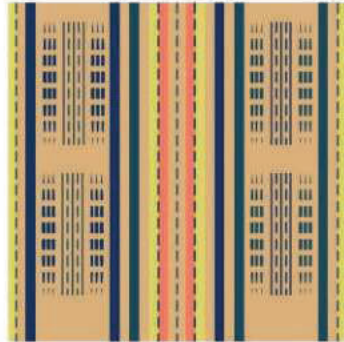


**5. Grey**  
Dyestuffs:  
Charcoal in Iron  
mordant.

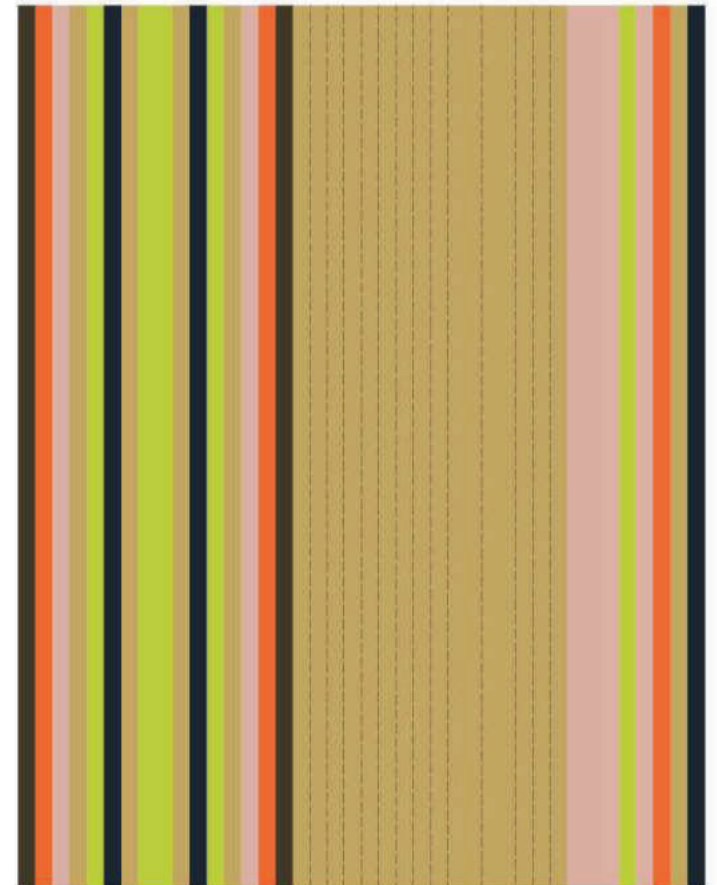


**6. Sandstone**  
Dyestuffs:  
Two parts  
madder in water.

## Stripes Explorations:



## Final Stripes:



## Textile Development Process photos:



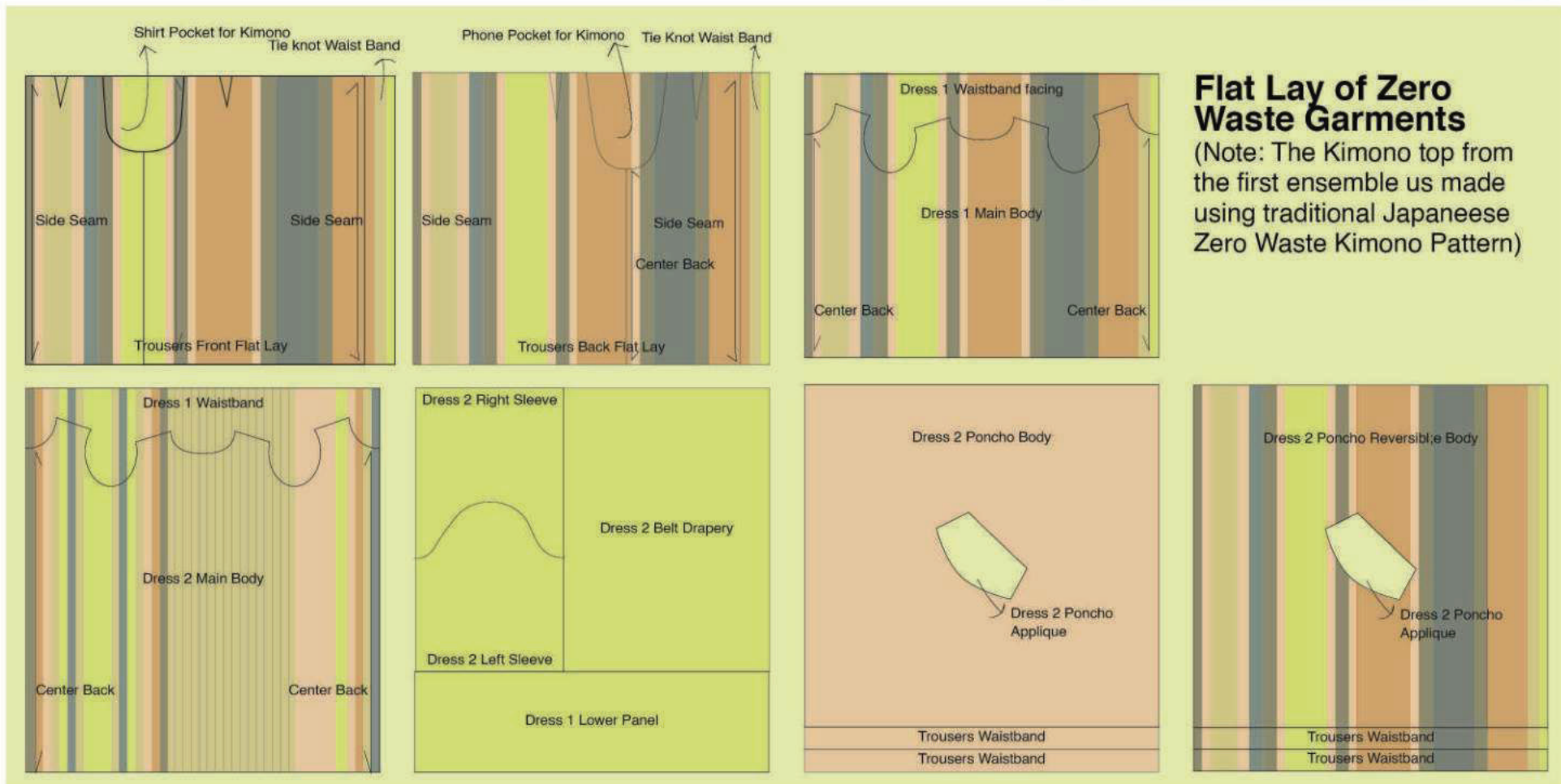
1. Handspinning the yarn.
2. Crushing Harda to form powder for mordanting.
3. Mordanting the yarn.
4. Air drying the fabric in shade.
5. Yarn from bobbin frame to warp drum.
6. Yarn from warp drum on warp beam.
7. Weighing of dried onion peels.
8. Dyeing of turmeric dyed yarn with onion peel solution to get the desired green colour.

## Working Sketches for collection:

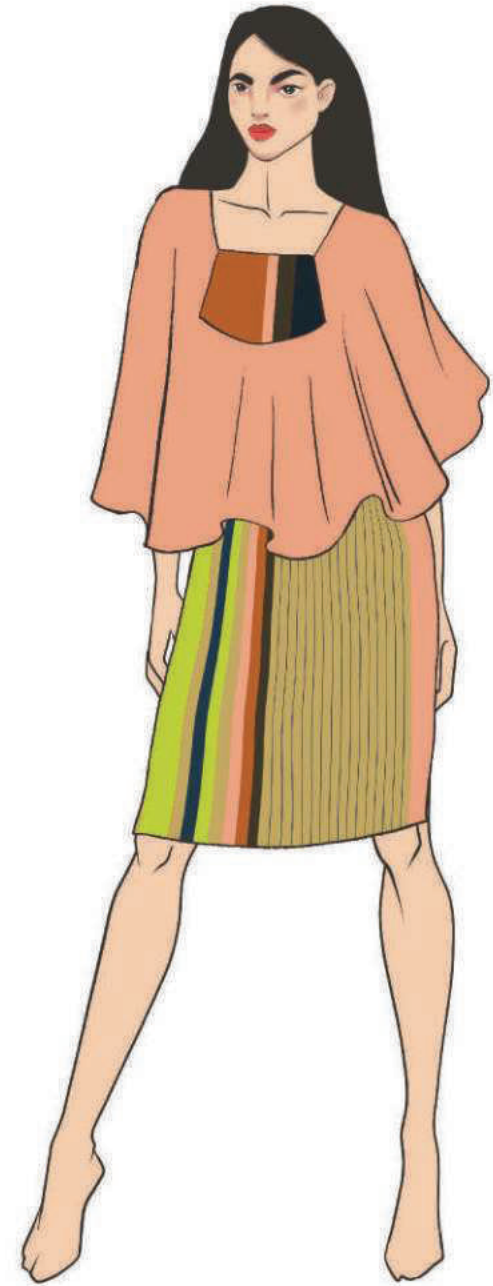


Keeping the inspiration in mind, a rough collection of ensembles was made. After testing each silhouette for an optimal fabric use, some tweaks were made which have been illustrated on the next page. Waste generated was incorporated in the collection in form of appliques.

## Fabric set on loom for weaving:



## Range Plan:



## 02 The Orient

A visit to the Rumtek Monastery, near Gangtok, Sikkim has inspired this collection. The Neo-Traditional theme showcases a combination of handwoven Indian Oriental fabrics fused with western and Japanese silhouettes. The striped visual patterns formed by the columns and windows of the monastery are depicted with the vibrant fabrics of the Hajong tribe. The traditional Rabha fabrics used for the collection are adorned with prominent intricate borders and overall diamond motifs. The western silhouettes like plunging dresses look bolder with the bright colorful patterns. Easy wide-legged pants are an essential highlight of the collection.

Keywords: East-West fusion, handwoven fabrics, bold stripes, ornamental, festive, unexpected pairings, easy-going silhouettes.





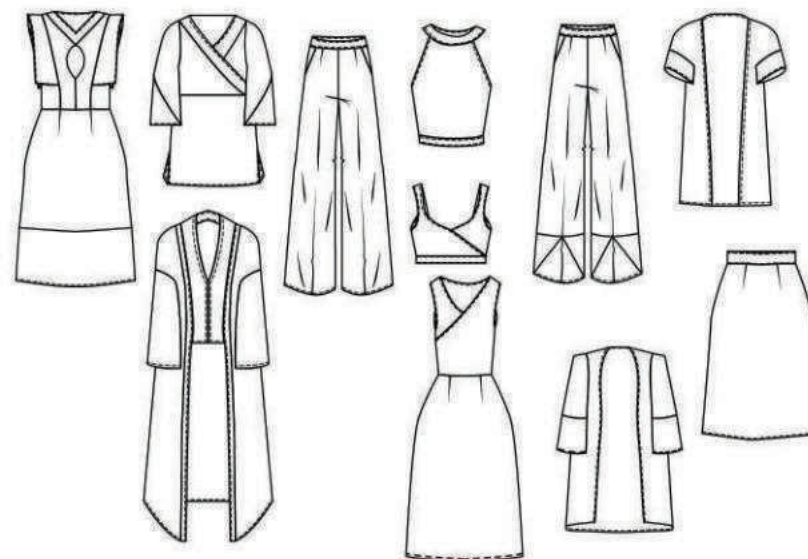
1. Traditional handwoven attires of the Rabha tribe of Assam consisting of women's Kambung(wrapping cloth) and Riphon(wrap around extending from the cleavage till toe) along with men's Pasra (Shoulder cloth worn during winters) are used in all the ensembles.

2. Pathin, the wrap around skirt worn by Hajong tribal women is also used in this collection. The Pathin usually comprises of alternate symmetric layers of stripes in between red stripes and thick borders known as 'chapa'.

## Rendered Explorations:



## Flats:



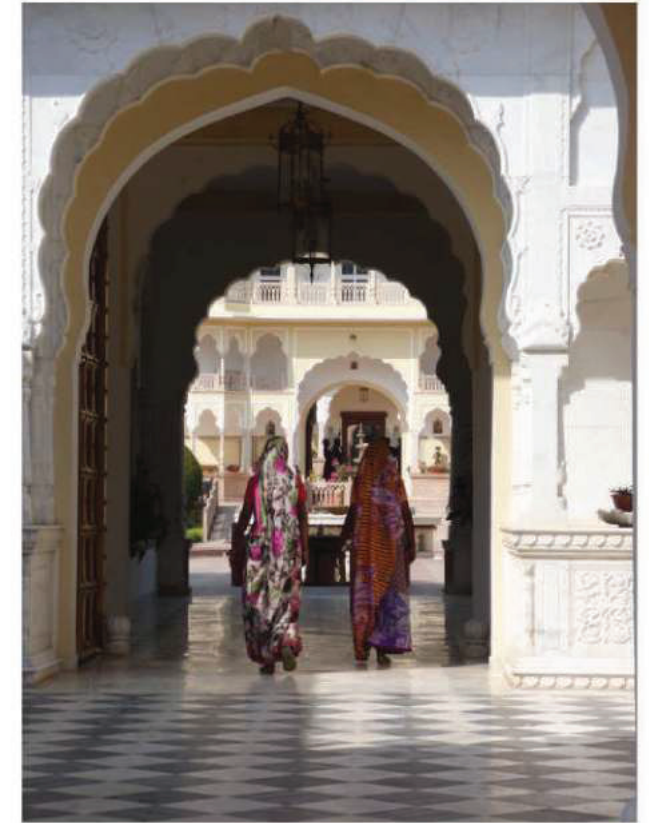
## Range Plan:



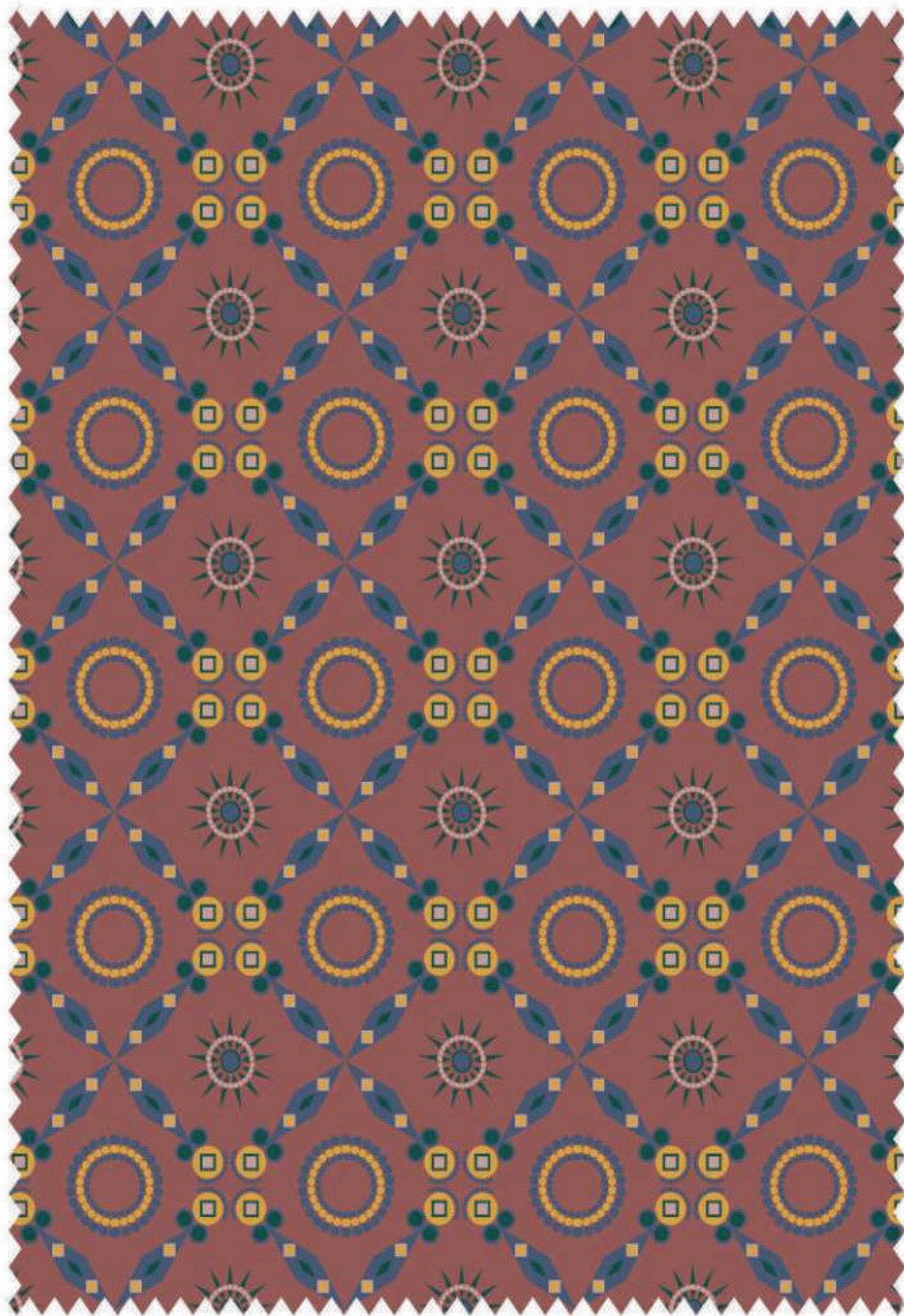
# 03 Sawai

Nahargarh Palace from Sawai Madhopur had some of the most striking mosaic tiles. These tiles inspired the print design collection. The muted colour palette is a reminiscence of an earthy feeling of the misty weather that I experienced during my time there.

Keywords: Mosaic, Geometric, Tessellated, Muted, Repeated.



**Print 1:**



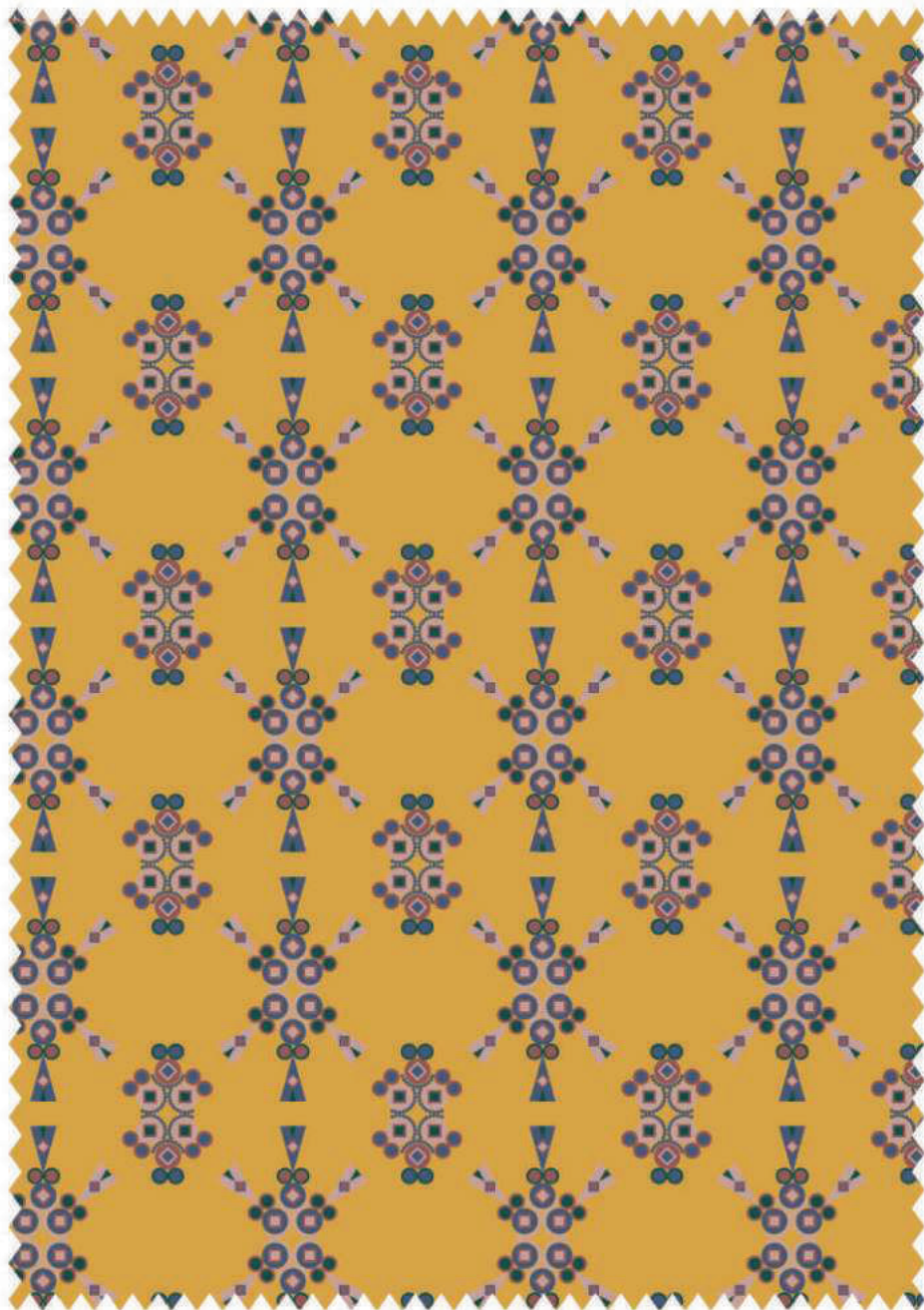
**Colourways:**



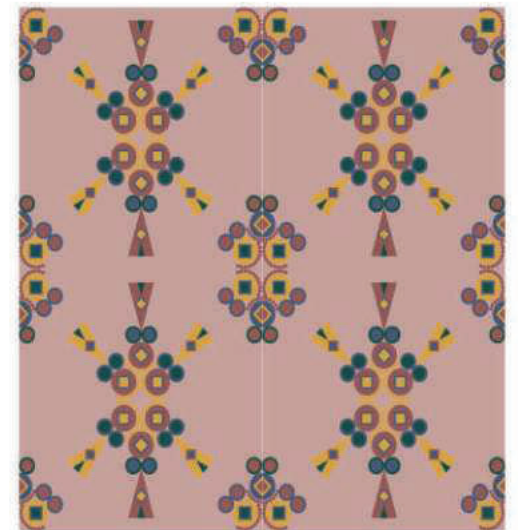
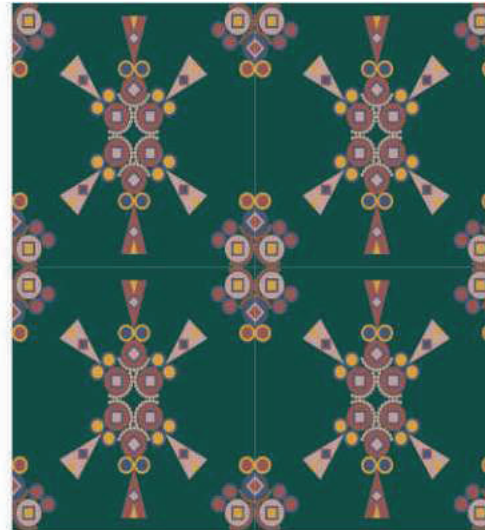
**Mockup:**



**Print 2:**



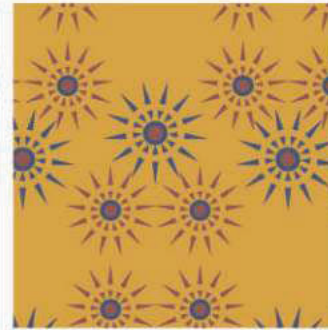
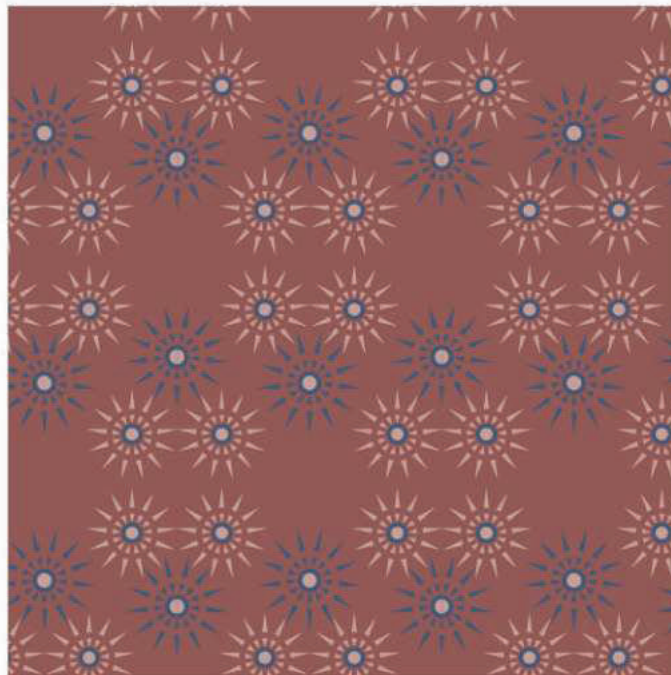
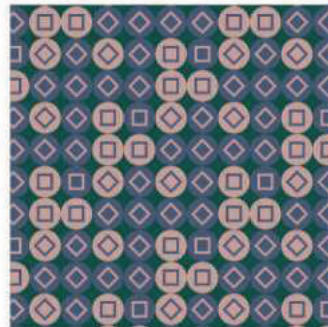
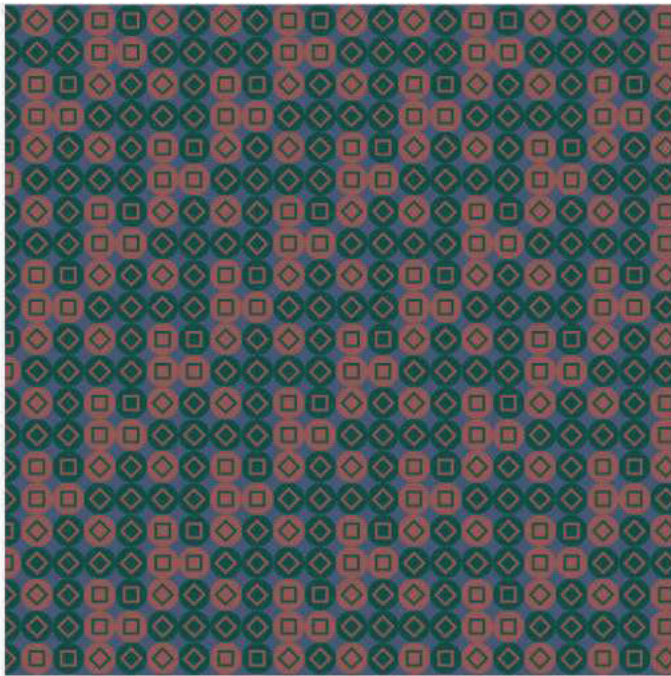
**Colourways:**



**Mockup:**



## Co-ordinates with colourways:



## Mockups:

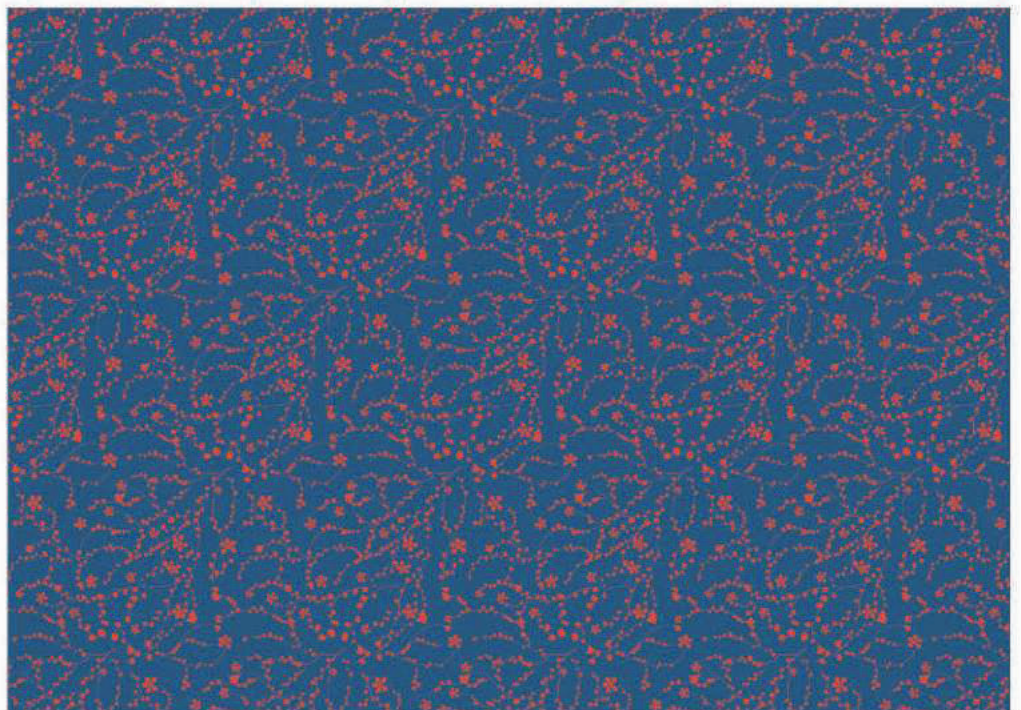
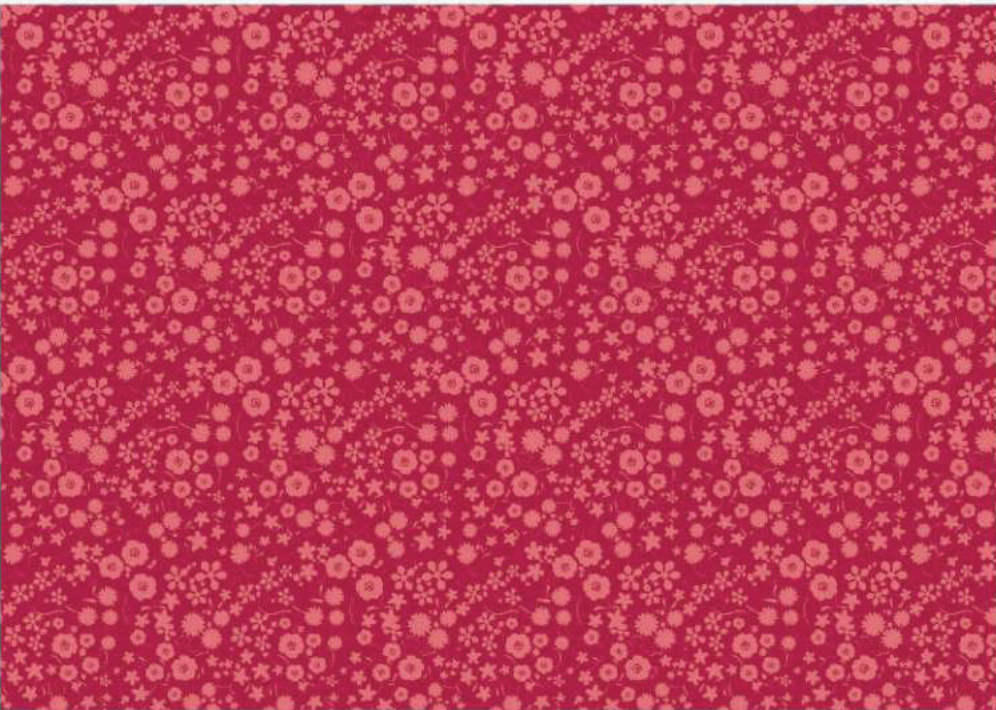
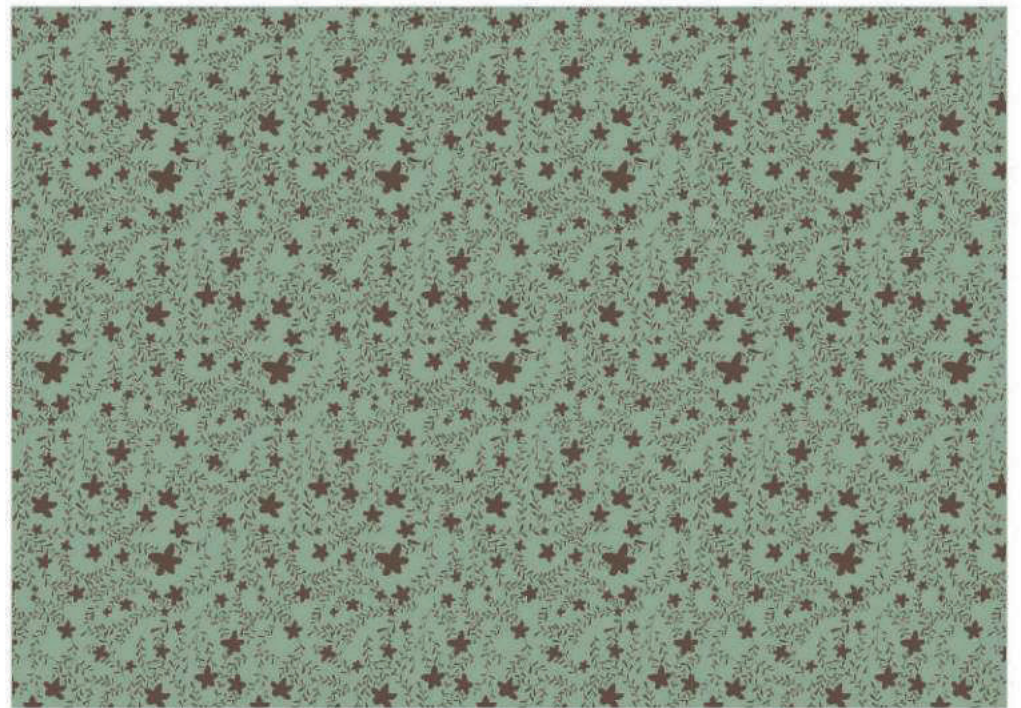
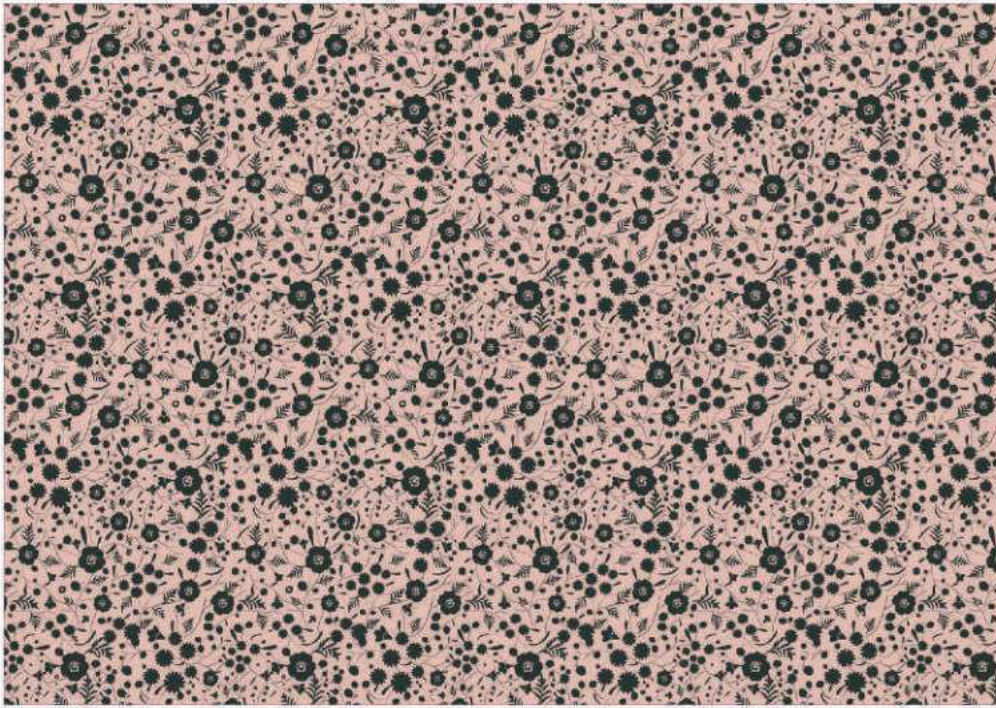


# 04 Blooming Abode

Four flowers are picked for designing prints for a sleepwear range. The flowers are poppy, ruby cinquefoil, bergenia, rhododendron. The shapes of the flowers are simplified for ditsy style monochromatic prints.





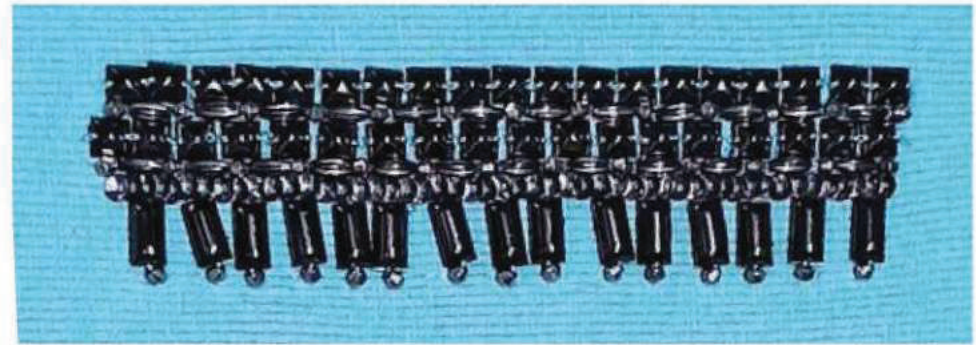
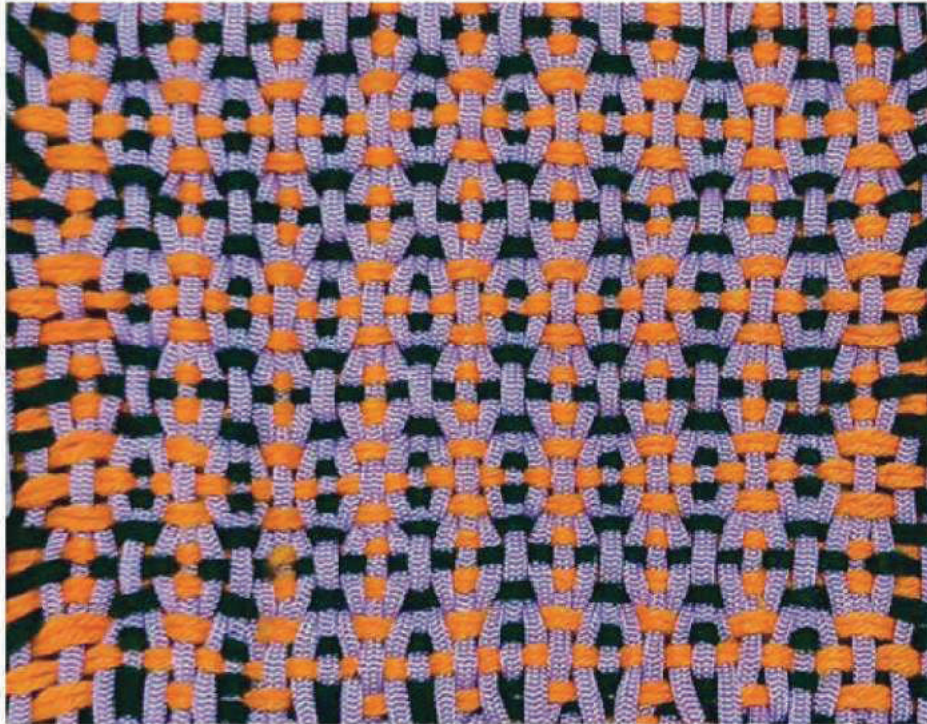


**Mockups:**



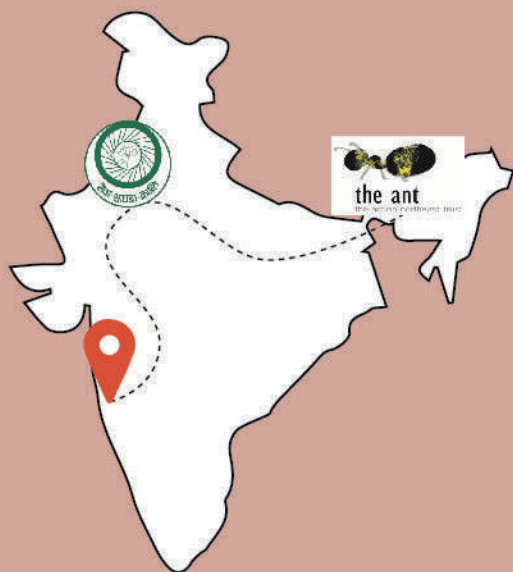
## 05 Textile Samples

This project comprises of a selection of some of the embroidery swatches that I have developed during college times and some samples that were prototyped during my internship.





# 06 Towards Better Livelihoods



1. Rural Development Orientation at Seva Mandir's Learning campus in Udaipur.
2. NGO allocated: the ant (the action north-east trust). Familiarization with NGO's various initiatives.

This Project aims at the documentation of my project under SBI Youth for India fellowship in partnership with the SBI Foundation and the ant (the action northeast trust). I have shared my journey into the development sector to work towards the thematic area of 'Traditional Crafts' and 'Social Entrepreneurship' is put forth.

|   |                         |                             |                                                                                                                                                                         |   |                                                                                                    |
|---|-------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 | Disha (NGO) Coordinator | Akhil Pradhan, 21st October | 1. High number of HIV infections among Female Sex Workers (FSWs), Disha is working in direct intervention through regular testing, providing treatment, and counselling | – | 1. Skill development, possibly in stitching (Aagor?), so as to provide an alternative to sex work. |
|---|-------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

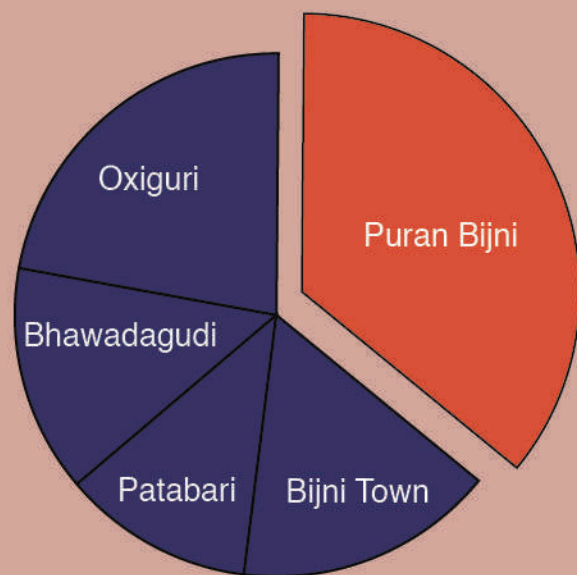
## Problem Identification:

Through field visits to various NGO project clusters, I met stakeholders like local artisans, ASHA Workers, VCDC members, local NGOs, etc.

During one such visit to Basugaon, Chirang, Assam I could identify a local TI working for sexual health amongst the FSWs (Female Sex Workers). There is a high number of HIV infections seen on ground amongst them. Some of them were looking for an alternate livelihood to sex work.

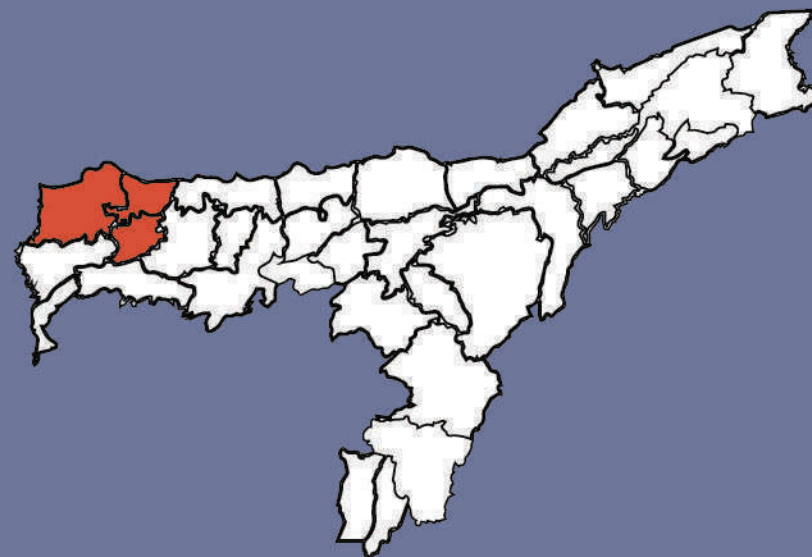


## Problem Statement Synopsis:



**The Pie Chart shows the concentration of FSWs in various regions in Chirang district:**

1. Highest Concentration (about 35%) is found in Puran Bijni.
2. It has a close proximity from Mangalian, where weavers are mostly based and from the Agor store (NGO weavers initiative) in Chapaguri.
3. Assam's fastest growing town, Bijni is 1.5 kms away from Puran Bijni which can be a good local market to explore.



**The Map highlights the districts of Chirang, Bongaigaon and Chirang in the state of Assam.**

The main problems identified here are:

1. Non-Availability of Critical Care Centers for HIV patients across 3 districts.
2. Poor Hygiene
3. Absence of organized Sex Work through brothels leading to severe underpayment.
4. Lack of Employment Opportunities.

**Creating a safe Workspace, Regular Training Workshops,  
Entrepreneurship Awareness Workshop with SBI RSETI, Kajalgaon:**



## Advancements during Training Workshops:



## Project Timeline Plan:

### Strengthening the JLG

By constant guidance and knowledge sharing.

### Market Linkages

Identify local order opportunities of consumer goods.

### Business plan finalization

Finalize on enterprise name, functions and products based on skills and market.

### Production

Start the production of first set of products that can be displayed and sold at IDeA meetings and events.

### Sewing Training

Completion of training and dissemination of UDYAM certification.

### Sampling

Based on training status and Agor requirements, develop new design samples.

### JLG loan application

Apply for a loan based on tested business plan for first set of production.

### Feedbacks

Gather customer feedback

## Challenges:

Local identity protection of the members due to social stigma around sex work.

Lack of a major market access. Nearest potential market (Bongaigaon) is 30 mins away.

Retaining certain members in the trainings due to irregular attendance.

## Sustainability of the Project:

Create and maintain local channels of orders for a steady income.

Can be absorbed into Agor as a production unit.

Identify youth in the community to promote the enterprise via social media and local channels.

 The End